Skippy for Linux User Guide

Install and use Skippy on a Linux desktop - version 1.19.1

Skippy is group video calling for up to 10 people: audio, video, chat, file transfer and direct calls. The Linux app is the same desktop app as on Windows. Like every Skippy app it connects to a Skippy server run by someone in your group, so you need that server's address and an account on it.

> **This is a test release.** The Linux builds start and run on GitHub's test machines, but they have not been used in a real call on a real desktop yet. If something doesn't work, please report it - see **Reporting a problem** at the end.

What you need

- A 64-bit Linux desktop with a recent distribution (Ubuntu 22.04 / Debian 12 / Fedora 38 or newer). **x86-64** PCs and **arm64** machines (for example a Raspberry Pi 4 or 5 running 64-bit Linux) are both supported.
- The **server address** from whoever runs your Skippy server, e.g. **100.64.0.10:8470**. If it starts with **100.** it is a Tailscale address: install Tailscale (tailscale.com/download), sign in to the server's account and run **tailscale up**.
- One file from the **latest release** at github.com/lrizio/Skippy/releases: the **.AppImage** (works on any distribution) or the **.deb** (Debian, Ubuntu, Mint, Raspberry Pi OS) for your processor (**x86_64/amd64** for ordinary PCs, **arm64** for ARM).

Install - choose one

Option A: AppImage (any distribution)

1. Download **Skippy-1.19.1-linux-x86_64.AppImage** (or **-arm64.AppImage**).
2. Make it runnable: right-click it, **Properties, Permissions, Allow executing file as program** - or in a terminal:

```
chmod +x Skippy-1.19.1-linux-x86_64.AppImage
./Skippy-1.19.1-linux-x86_64.AppImage
```

An AppImage doesn't install anything; keep it somewhere like **~/Applications**. To update, download the new file and delete the old one. If it won't start because of **FUSE**, install it (**sudo apt install libfuse2** on Ubuntu 22.04/Debian; **libfuse2t64** on Ubuntu 24.04), or run it with **--appimage-extract-and-run**.

Option B: .deb package (Debian / Ubuntu family)

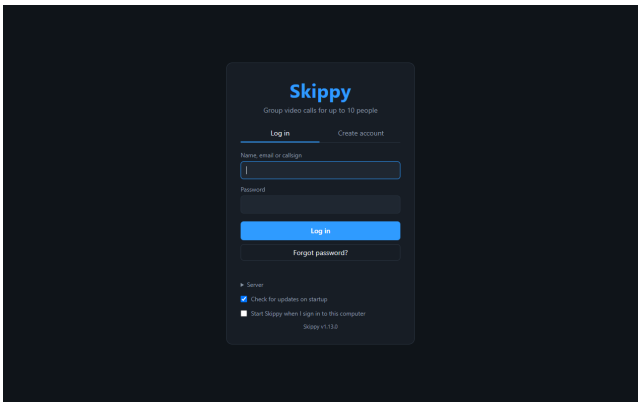
```
sudo apt install ./Skippy-1.19.1-linux-amd64.deb
```

(Use the **-arm64.deb** file on an ARM machine.) Skippy then appears in your applications menu, and **skippy** starts it from a terminal. Remove it with **sudo apt remove skippy**.

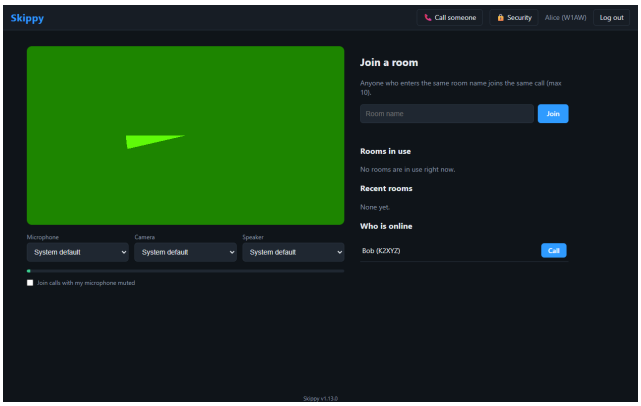
> **"The SUID sandbox helper binary was not configured correctly"** (or the AppImage closes at once on Ubuntu 23.10 / 24.04 and newer). Ubuntu now restricts the sandbox that Electron apps use. The .deb normally works as it is. For the AppImage, either run it with **--no-sandbox**, or allow it once with: **sudo sysctl -w kernel.apparmor_restrict_unprivileged_userns=0** (this lowers a system-wide protection, so prefer the .deb or **--no-sandbox** if you are unsure).

First start

1. Start **Skippy**. On the login screen open **Server** and type the server address (**ws://** at the front is optional).
2. Create an account or log in; save the **recovery key** - it is the only way back in if you forget your password.
3. Allow camera and microphone if your desktop asks (Flatpak/Snap-style prompts only; a normal install uses them directly).



Login screen (Windows shown; the Linux window is identical).



The lobby: preview, devices, rooms and who is online.

Linux specifics

Topic	On Linux
Tray icon / closing the window	Skippy sits in the system tray; the window's close button **hides** it so calls can still come in. **GNOME hides tray icons by default**: install the *AppIndicator and KStatusNotifierItem Support* extension (Ubuntu has it built in) to see it. Without a tray you can always bring the window back by starting Skippy again, and quit it from the tray menu or with **Ctrl+Q**.
Start at login	Tray menu, **Start when I sign in to this computer**. Skippy then starts hidden.
Screen sharing	Click **Share**. On **X11** pick a screen or window in Skippy's list. On **Wayland** (the default on Ubuntu, Fedora) your desktop shows its own picker through **PipeWire**; this needs **xdg-desktop-portal** and the portal for your desktop (**xdg-desktop-portal-gnome** or **-kde**). If sharing fails, try starting Skippy with **--ozone-platform=x11**.
Camera / microphone / speaker	Pick them under **Devices**. A camera must be a normal V4L2 webcam (**/dev/video0**); you need to be allowed to use it (usually automatic on a desktop login).
Tailscale warning	If the server is on Tailscale and it is off, Skippy shows a banner; the button runs **tailscale up** (needs **tailscale set --operator=$USER** once if it asks for sudo).
Recording and transcripts	**Record** saves one audio track per speaker to **~/Documents/Skippy Recordings**. Transcripts need the **whisper.cpp** speech engine: build it (github.com/ggml-org/whisper.cpp) and put **whisper-cli** on your PATH or in **~/.local/bin**; then Skippy's transcript setup downloads the language model (about 190 MB) once.

Running the server on Linux

The server runs well on Linux (a small VPS, a Raspberry Pi, a home server). Install Node.js 22.13 or newer, download **Skippy-Server-<version>.zip** from the Releases page (the newest one that has it), unzip, and in that folder:

```
npm install
node server.js
```

It listens on port **8470** and keeps its data in **skippy.db** next to it. To keep it running, a systemd service works (example, untested - adjust the user and paths):

```
# /etc/systemd/system/skippy-server.service
[Unit]
Description=Skippy server
After=network-online.target
[Service]
User=skippy
WorkingDirectory=/opt/skippy-server
ExecStart=/usr/bin/node server.js
Restart=always
[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
```

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
"Could not reach the server"	Switch on Tailscale (if the address is 100.x), check address and port, and that the server is running.
AppImage does nothing or complains about FUSE / sandbox	See the install section: **libfuse2**, or **--appimage-extract-and-run**, or **--no-sandbox**.
No window after closing it	It is hidden in the tray. Start Skippy again, or use the tray menu.
Black video from my camera	Close other programs using the camera; check **v4l2-ctl --list-devices**; pick the camera under **Devices**.
Can't hear others	Check the output device under **Devices** and in your sound settings (PipeWire/PulseAudio).
Screen share is black or fails	On Wayland make sure the desktop portal is installed; or try **--ozone-platform=x11**.
Forgot my password	Use **Forgot password?** on the login screen with your recovery key.

Reporting a problem

Open an issue at **github.com/lrizio/Skippy/issues** and say:

- Skippy **version** (shown as "Skippy v..." on the login and lobby screens) and which file you used (AppImage or deb, x86_64 or arm64).
- Your **distribution and version**, desktop (GNOME, KDE...) and whether it is **Wayland or X11** (**echo $XDG_SESSION_TYPE**).
- What you did, what you expected and what happened. If Skippy won't start, run it from a terminal and paste the messages it prints.
- Please **don't** include passwords, recovery keys or a private server address.

Also useful: tell the author what *did* work, so it can be marked as verified.

Skippy for Linux shares its code with the Windows desktop app (v1.19.1); the desktop User Guide covers accounts, rooms and the server in more detail. Source and releases: github.com/lrizio/Skippy.